# Ijebu Hotel and Shortlet Booking Platform PRD

Nov 9, 2026 · @Tiamiyu Adetayo

## Summary

Build a hotel and shortlet apartment booking marketplace for the Ijebu Ode axis, powered by simple property management tools, and launch publicly before Ojude Oba in about May 2027. These tools keep room and apartment availability accurate, and accurate availability makes the marketplace trustworthy.

The platform has four connected products on one backend: guest mobile and web apps, a landing website, a Partner Dashboard for hotels and shortlet hosts, and a Platform Admin.

This draft was prepared without live market research. Hotel counts, legal points, festival dates, fees and all naira figures are working assumptions to validate during discovery.

## Problem

| Who | Problem today | Consequence |
|---|---|---|
| Guests | Hotel details, photos and prices are scattered across calls, WhatsApp and outdated listings | They cannot tell which hotels are genuine or whether a room is truly available |
| Hotel owners | Records often sit in paper ledgers, with cash and transfers handled at the desk | Absentee owners have little visibility and face revenue leakage |
| Hotel staff | Walk-ins, calls and online requests are tracked in different places | Double-bookings and slow check-in |
| Hotels during events | Festival and event demand is hard to see ahead of time | Missed pricing and planning opportunities |
| Shortlet guests | Apartments are often advertised through agents and social media with little proof | Risk of fake listings and deposit disputes |

| Who | Problem today | Consequence |
|---|---|---|
| Shortlet owners | Bookings, caretakers and cleaning are coordinated by phone | Calendar clashes, unclear earnings and damage disputes |

## Vision and positioning

**Vision:** become the most trusted way to find, book and run a hotel or shortlet in Ijebu, then repeat the model in neighbouring towns.

- **Promise to guests:** Verified hotels and shortlets in Ijebu. Real photos, real prices, room guaranteed.
- **Promise to owners:** See every room or apartment night sold and every naira collected from your phone, even when you are in Lagos.
- **Local advantage:** in-person property verification, landmark-based search, and filters for power, water and security.
- **Launch moment:** Ojude Oba, when demand peaks and visitors arrive from outside the area.

## Goals for the first 12 months

1. Make the platform the default digital booking channel for verified hotels and shortlets in the axis.
2. Get hotels and shortlet hosts using the dashboard daily, so that availability stays accurate.
3. Prove guests will book and pay online, and return.
4. Validate a revenue model that can fund expansion.

**Out of scope for launch:** channel sync with global platforms, restaurant and inventory management, public hourly room listings, pay-at-hotel for online bookings, and towns outside the axis.

## Market and users

The market is small and dense, so depth of partnership matters more than listing volume. The axis probably has only a few dozen bookable hotels. The number of shortlet apartments is unknown, so discovery must count both.

**Demand sources to validate:** Ojude Oba and other festivals, weddings and burials, family reunions, OOU and TASUED events, business travel, expressway transit stays, returning diaspora visits, extended family stays and staff on longer work assignments.

| Persona | Main need | What wins them |
|---|---|---|
| Local or Lagos traveller | A reliable room at a known total price | Verified photos, instant confirmation, transfer payment |
| Diaspora or relative booking for family | Book for someone else with confidence | Shareable confirmation, secure online payment |
| Festival visitor | Secure a room before they sell out | Early access, event guide |
| Event organiser | Rooms for many guests | Group booking and a single invoice |
| Absentee hotel owner | Visibility and control | Phone dashboard, audit log, exception alerts |
| Hotel manager or receptionist | Fast, simple daily work | Walk-in booking in under 30 seconds, QR check-in |
| Housekeeper | Know which rooms to clean | Simple room list on a phone |
| Platform team | Keep supply and bookings trustworthy | Verification, support and finance tools |
| Family or group staying together | A private space with a kitchen and several bedrooms | Verified apartment details and clear whole-unit pricing |
| Shortlet owner | Earn safely from an apartment, often from a distance | Verified guests, deposit protection and earnings statements |
| Property manager or caretaker | Manage several units and handovers | Multi-unit calendar, cleaning and check-in tasks |

## Competition

The strongest competitors are existing habits, not other apps.

| Alternative | Strength | How we win |
|---|---|---|
| Phone, WhatsApp and walk-ins | Familiar, direct and free | Confirmed availability, guarantees, and WhatsApp built into the experience |
| Google Maps | Where many searches begin | Claim and improve partner listings, and link them to booking |
| Hotels.ng and Booking.com | Brand and reach | Local verification, lower commission and hotel operations tools |
| Instagram and travel agents | Visual reach and personal trust | Partner with creators and agents using tracked booking links |
| Airbnb | Global trust and mature host tools | Local inspection, bank transfer and USSD payment, and on-the-ground support |
| Shortlet agents on Instagram and WhatsApp | Personal trust and quick replies | Verified apartments, protected payment and clear refund rules |

## Hotels and shortlets compared

Add shortlets as a second property type on the same platform, starting with a small set of inspected apartments. They widen the audience to families and groups, but carry higher trust and damage risks than hotels.

| Area | Hotel | Shortlet apartment | Product implication |
|---|---|---|---|
| What is booked | A room from a room type with several units | One whole, unique apartment | The data model must treat each apartment as its own bookable unit |
| Typical guest | Individuals, couples, transit and business travellers | Families, groups, diaspora visitors and longer stays | Search needs bedrooms, guest capacity and a property type filter |

| Area | Hotel | Shortlet apartment | Product implication |
|---|---|---|---|
| Operator | Staff on-site, with a front desk | Owner, agent or caretaker, often off-site | Hosts need a lighter, phone-first dashboard with no front desk flow |
| Check-in | At reception | Key handover, caretaker or lock access | Add check-in instructions, released only after payment |
| Pricing | Nightly rate plus taxes | Nightly rate, cleaning fee and refundable caution deposit | Show every charge separately before payment |
| Stay rules | Hotel policy | Minimum nights, occupancy limits and house rules | Rules must be accepted during booking |
| Main trust risk | Room condition and overbooking | Fake listings, parties, damage and deposit disputes | Require ownership checks, guest verification and condition photos |
| Availability risk | Walk-ins not recorded | The same apartment listed on several platforms | Calendar sync becomes important early |
| Daily software need | High, because operations run every day | Lower for single-unit owners, higher for managers | Single-unit hosts stay on the free plan; multi-unit managers pay |
| Festival value | Limited by room count | Absorbs groups when hotels are full | Feature apartments prominently for Ojude Oba |

**Launch approach:** inspect and approve every apartment before it goes live, and prefer professional managers and hosts who are easy to reach. Do not open shortlet self-listing until verification and dispute handling are proven.

## Business model

Combine a low commission with a software subscription, because commission alone is thin in a small market. All prices below are hypotheses to test with owners.

| Revenue stream | Working assumption | When |
|---|---|---|
| Hotel booking commission | 8–12% of room value | Launch |
| Basic hotel tool | Free, to drive adoption | Launch |
| Pro plan with advanced insights | ₦15,000–₦30,000 per hotel per month | After the festival |
| Featured listings | Paid placement, clearly labelled | After the festival |
| Group and event bookings | Service fee per event | After the festival |
| Shortlet booking commission | 10–15% of nightly rate, excluding cleaning fees and refundable deposits | Launch |
| Host plan for multi-unit managers | ₦3,000–₦7,000 per unit per month | After the festival |

**Worked example:** at ₦25,000 per night and 10% commission, each room-night earns ₦2,500. Reaching ₦2 million a month would take 800 room-nights. Thirty hotels at ₦20,000 a month would add a predictable ₦600,000. A shortlet at ₦60,000 per night and 12% would earn ₦7,200 per night, though each unit will have fewer bookings than a whole hotel.

## Functional requirements

P0 is needed for public launch, P1 follows after the festival, and P2 is later. Each requirement has an ID so that design, engineering and testing can trace it.

### Guest mobile and web apps

| ID | Requirement | Priority |
|---|---|---|
| G-01 | Search by date, guests, price, area and property type (hotel or shortlet), with list and map views | P0 |
| G-02 | Search near landmarks such as OOU, TASUED, the Awujale's palace and the expressway | P0 |

| ID | Requirement | Priority |
|---|---|---|
| G-03 | Filter by power hours, generator, water, parking, security, AC, Wi-Fi, restaurant and event hall | P0 |
| G-04 | Hotel and room pages with verified photos and a verified badge | P0 |
| G-05 | Show the full price upfront, including all taxes and fees | P0 |
| G-06 | Phone number and OTP sign-in, with guest checkout | P0 |
| G-07 | Pay by card, bank transfer or USSD | P0 |
| G-08 | Pay part or all at the hotel, where the hotel allows it (upcoming feature) | P1 |
| G-09 | Confirmation by WhatsApp, SMS and email, with a check-in QR code | P0 |
| G-10 | Book on behalf of someone else | P0 |
| G-11 | View, modify and cancel bookings, and track refund status | P0 |
| G-12 | Directions, and one-tap call or WhatsApp to the hotel | P0 |
| G-13 | Reviews from verified stays only | P0 |
| G-14 | Event hub with festival dates, guides and early booking access | P0 |
| G-15 | Loyalty points and referral rewards | P1 |
| G-16 | Group and event booking | P1 |
| G-17 | Price alerts and a best-dates calendar | P1 |
| G-18 | Day-use rooms, corporate accounts and pickup | P2 |
| G-19 | Digital check-in and in-stay requests | P2 |
| G-20 | Yoruba language support | P2 |

## Landing website

| ID | Requirement | Priority |
|---|---|---|
| L-01 | Separate value propositions for guests, hotel owners and shortlet hosts | P0 |
| L-02 | "List your property" lead form | P0 |
| L-03 | SEO pages such as "hotels in Ijebu Ode", "hotels near OOU" and "shortlets in Ijebu Ode" | P0 |
| L-04 | Trust, refund and privacy policy pages, plus support contact | P0 |
| L-05 | App download links and search linked to the web app | P0 |
| L-06 | Event landing pages and travel guides | P0 |

## Partner Dashboard

| ID | Requirement | Priority |
|---|---|---|
| H-01 | Hotel profile, room types, individual rooms and amenities | P0 |
| H-02 | Base, weekend and seasonal pricing | P0 |
| H-03 | Visual availability calendar with room blocking | P0 |
| H-04 | Walk-in booking in under 30 seconds, syncing to online availability | P0 |
| H-05 | Check-in, check-out and digital guest register | P0 |
| H-06 | Housekeeping status by room | P0 |
| H-07 | Shift cash and transfer reconciliation | P0 |
| H-08 | Staff accounts with owner, manager, receptionist and housekeeping roles | P0 |
| H-09 | Audit log of every booking, price and payment change | P0 |

| ID | Requirement | Priority |
|---|---|---|
| H-10 | Instant new-booking alerts and a daily WhatsApp summary | P0 |
| H-11 | Payouts, statements and commission reports | P0 |
| H-12 | Respond to reviews | P0 |
| H-13 | Mobile-friendly design that tolerates brief network drops | P0 |
| H-14 | Direct booking link and QR code for each hotel | P0 |
| H-15 | Multi-property management | P1 |
| H-16 | Channel sync with Booking.com and others | P2 |
| H-17 | Restaurant billing, inventory and hall booking | P2 |

## Owner insights

| ID | Requirement | Priority |
|---|---|---|
| I-01 | Occupancy, average room rate, RevPAR and revenue by room type | P0 |
| I-02 | Booking sources, cancellations, no-shows and lead time | P0 |
| I-03 | Exception alerts where rooms occupied do not match money recorded | P0 |
| I-04 | Local event calendar showing upcoming demand | P0 |
| I-05 | Pricing suggestions based on demand and events | P1 |
| I-06 | Anonymous area benchmarks, shown only where enough hotels take part | P1 |
| I-07 | Review themes and exportable reports | P1 |

## Platform Admin

| ID | Requirement | Priority |
|---|---|---|
| A-01 | Hotel and host onboarding, document checks and verification status | P0 |
| A-02 | Listing approval and content management | P0 |
| A-03 | Booking oversight, refunds and dispute handling | P0 |
| A-04 | Commission settings, settlements and payment reconciliation | P0 |
| A-05 | Review moderation and fraud flags | P0 |
| A-06 | Role-based admin access and full audit logs | P0 |
| A-07 | Marketplace analytics, including zero-result searches and hotel health | P0 |
| A-08 | Promo codes and event calendar management | P0 |
| A-09 | Featured placement and subscription billing | P1 |

## Shortlet apartments

These requirements extend the guest apps, Partner Dashboard and Platform Admin.

| ID | Requirement | Priority |
|---|---|---|
| S-01 | Whole-apartment listings with bedrooms, beds, bathrooms, kitchen, living area and maximum guests | P0 |
| S-02 | Filter by bedrooms, guest capacity and kitchen | P0 |
| S-03 | Show nightly rate, cleaning fee, refundable caution deposit and total before payment | P0 |
| S-04 | Minimum stay, occupancy limit and house rules accepted during booking | P0 |
| S-05 | Guest ID verification before check-in details are released | P0 |

| ID | Requirement | Priority |
|---|---|---|
| S-06 | Check-in instructions and caretaker contact released after payment | P0 |
| S-07 | Phone-first host dashboard for calendar, pricing, bookings and earnings | P0 |
| S-08 | Multi-unit view for property managers | P0 |
| S-09 | Caretaker role with check-in and cleaning tasks | P0 |
| S-10 | Check-in and check-out condition photos | P0 |
| S-11 | Caution deposit return or claim flow (pending decision) | P0 |
| S-12 | Host identity, ownership or management authority checks, and physical inspection | P0 |
| S-13 | Deposit dispute and damage claim handling in Platform Admin | P0 |
| S-14 | Insights for nights booked, average nightly rate, length of stay, empty gap nights and earnings per unit | P0 |
| S-15 | Masked in-app messaging between guests and hosts | P1 |
| S-16 | Calendar sync with Airbnb and Booking.com | P1 |
| S-17 | Weekly and monthly stay discounts | P1 |
| S-18 | Owner statements for property managers | P1 |
| S-19 | Open self-listing for hosts, with verification before going live | P2 |
| S-20 | Smart lock access | P2 |

## User stories

Each story links to the requirements it depends on.

| ID | As a | I want to | So that | Links |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| US-01 | Traveller | Search by area and date | I only see rooms I can actually book | G-01, G-02 |
| US-02 | First-time visitor | See verified photos and recent reviews | I know the hotel is real | G-04, G-13 |
| US-03 | Price-conscious guest | See the total cost upfront | I am not surprised at the desk | G-05 |
| US-04 | Lagos-based guest | Check power, water and security | I can choose a comfortable stay | G-03 |
| US-05 | Guest with no card | Pay by bank transfer or USSD | I can still book | G-07 |
| US-06 | Relative booking for parents | Send them the confirmation | They can check in without me | G-09, G-10 |
| US-07 | Guest | Receive confirmation on WhatsApp | I can find my booking without opening the app | G-09 |
| US-08 | Guest whose plans changed | Cancel and track my refund | I do not have to chase anyone | G-11 |
| US-09 | Festival visitor | Get a guide and early access | I secure a room before they sell out | G-14 |
| US-10 | Event organiser | Reserve many rooms on one invoice | My guests are all sorted | G-16 |
| US-11 | Past guest | Leave a review | Others can decide better | G-13 |
| US-12 | Owner | See revenue and occupancy on my phone | I can manage remotely | I-01, H-13 |
| US-13 | Owner | Get alerts when records do not add up | I can catch revenue leakage | I-03, H-09 |
| US-14 | Owner | Control staff permissions | Only trusted people change prices or delete bookings | H-08 |

| ID | As a | I want to | So that | Links |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| US-15 | Owner | See high-demand dates early | I can adjust prices in time | I-04, H-02 |
| US-16 | Owner | See where bookings come from | I can spend marketing money wisely | I-02 |
| US-17 | Owner | Get clear payout statements | I can trust the platform | H-11 |
| US-18 | Owner | Be onboarded with help | I can go live without technical skill | A-01, H-01 |
| US-19 | Receptionist | Record a walk-in quickly | The room disappears from online availability | H-04 |
| US-20 | Receptionist | Scan a QR code at arrival | Check-in is fast and accurate | G-09, H-05 |
| US-21 | Receptionist | Close my shift with a summary | My records are clear | H-07 |
| US-22 | Housekeeper | See rooms to clean and mark them ready | The desk knows what can be sold | H-06 |
| US-23 | Verification officer | Review documents and inspection notes | Only genuine hotels go live | A-01, A-02 |
| US-24 | Support agent | See a full booking and payment timeline | I can resolve disputes fast | A-03 |
| US-25 | Finance officer | Match payments to payouts automatically | Errors surface quickly | A-04 |
| US-26 | Marketer | See unmet searches | I know which areas and dates need more hotels | A-07 |

## Shortlet stories

| ID | As a | I want to | So that | Links |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| US-27 | Family traveller | Find a whole apartment by bedrooms and capacity | We can all stay together | G-01, S-01, S-02 |

| ID | As a | I want to | So that | Links |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| US-28 | Shortlet guest | See that an apartment was physically inspected | I know it is not a scam | S-12 |
| US-29 | Shortlet guest | See cleaning fees and deposits before paying | I know exactly what I am paying and getting back | S-03 |
| US-30 | Shortlet guest | Receive check-in instructions after payment | I can get in without chasing anyone | S-06 |
| US-31 | Shortlet guest | Track my caution deposit | I know when it will be returned | S-11 |
| US-32 | Festival group | Book an apartment when hotels are full | We can stay together for Ojude Oba | G-14, S-01 |
| US-33 | Shortlet owner | Know guests are verified | My apartment is safer | S-05 |
| US-34 | Shortlet owner | Set minimum stays and house rules | Guests know what is allowed | S-04 |
| US-35 | Shortlet owner | Manage my calendar and earnings by phone | I can run the apartment remotely | S-07, S-14 |
| US-36 | Shortlet owner | Claim for damage with photo evidence | I can recover genuine costs | S-10, S-11, S-13 |
| US-37 | Property manager | See all my units in one place | I can avoid clashes and gaps | S-08, S-14 |
| US-38 | Property manager | Keep my calendar in sync with other platforms | An apartment is never double-booked | S-16 |
| US-39 | Caretaker | See check-ins and cleaning tasks | Each apartment is ready on time | S-09 |
| US-40 | Verification officer | Record ownership proof and inspection results | Only genuine apartments go live | A-01, S-12 |
| US-41 | Support agent | Review deposit claims with evidence | I can resolve disputes fairly | S-13 |

# Acceptance criteria for critical flows

### Booking and availability

- A room is held for 10–15 minutes during payment.
- Two guests can never hold or pay for the last room at the same time.
- A hold that expires returns the room to availability automatically.
- A walk-in updates online availability within seconds whenever the desk is connected.

### Payment

- A booking is confirmed only after the payment provider's verified webhook.
- A repeated webhook or retried payment never creates a second booking or charge.
- A payment that succeeds after its hold expired triggers either confirmation, if the room is still free, or an automatic refund.

### Booking guarantee

- If a confirmed room is unavailable, the guest is moved to an equal or better hotel at the platform's or hotel's cost, or fully refunded.
- Every guarantee case is logged against the hotel's health score.

### Owner exception alert

- An alert is raised when a room is marked occupied or needing cleaning with no matching booking or payment.
- Deleted or edited bookings and payments always remain visible in the audit log.

### Reviews

- Only a guest with a completed stay can leave a review.
- A hotel can reply to or report a review, but cannot edit or delete it.

### Shortlet booking and handover

- An apartment can be booked only when every night of the stay is free.
- A stay shorter than the minimum, or above the guest limit, cannot be submitted.
- Check-in details are released only after payment and guest ID verification.
- The caution deposit is shown separately and is never included in commission.
- The deposit is returned automatically after the agreed period unless the host files a claim with evidence.
- Changing an approved apartment's address or verified photos requires re-approval.

# Non-functional requirements

The product must work well on low-end Android phones and weak networks. Targets below are proposed starting points.

| Area | Requirement |
|---|---|
| Devices | Support low-end Android phones first, plus current iOS versions |
| Performance | Search results within 3 seconds on a typical 3G or 4G connection |
| Data use | Compressed images and small app size |
| Network failure | Dashboard shows unsynced state clearly and retries actions safely |
| Availability | 99.5% monthly uptime, with extra capacity tested before the festival |
| Data integrity | Atomic availability changes and idempotent payment processing |
| Security | Encryption in transit and at rest, role-based access and audit logs |
| Backups | Daily backups with a tested restore process |
| Accessibility | Readable contrast, large tap targets and simple language |
| Expansion | Multi-city, multi-property data model supporting hotel rooms and whole apartments from day one |

**Suggested technology:** one shared API, a cross-platform mobile app, and a responsive web app. Expo with a Laravel API is a sensible choice if that is the team's existing stack.

**Key integrations:** Paystack or Flutterwave, WhatsApp Business API, an SMS provider, maps, email, push notifications and image storage.

# Policies to define before launch

| Policy | Decision required |
| --- | --- |
| Cancellation | Standard tiers that hotels and hosts choose from, shown clearly before payment |
| No-show | How much is charged, and who keeps it |
| Refunds | Timeline, who bears gateway fees, and how status is communicated |
| Booking guarantee | Who pays for rebooking, and what happens to repeat offenders |
| Property condition | How guests report a hotel that does not match its listing |
| Short stays | Recommended: no public hourly listings at launch, and clearly defined day-use later |
| Guest safety | Rules for under-age guests, ID collection and staff access to guest data |
| Off-platform bookings | Incentives first: low commission, loyalty rewards and useful hotel tools |
| Caution deposit | Amount limits, who holds it, return period and claim deadline |
| Damage claims | Evidence required, decision timeline and limits on claims |
| Parties and occupancy | Recommended: no parties or extra guests without host approval, with clear penalties |
| Cleaning fee | Whether hosts set it freely or within a cap |
| Host cancellation | Penalties and guest rebooking support |
| Apartment handover | Who meets the guest, and what happens if access fails on arrival |

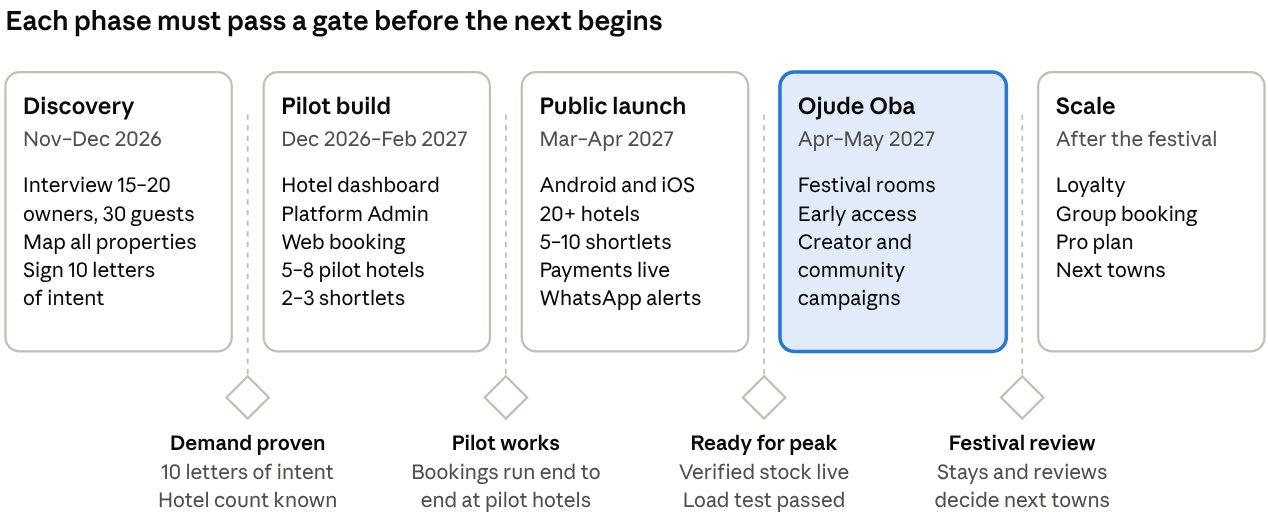
# Legal and compliance

These items need confirmation from a Nigerian lawyer and accountant before launch.

| Area | Action |
|---|---|
| Company | Register with CAC |
| Data protection | Comply with the Nigeria Data Protection Act, including privacy notice, consent and retention rules |
| Payments | Use a licensed provider with split settlement, and take legal advice on whether the flow requires any licence |
| Hotel licensing | Check Ogun State hotel licensing and guest registration rules, and make licence evidence part of verification |
| Tax | Confirm VAT and any state hotel tax, and how each appears on invoices |
| Contracts | Hotel partner agreement, guest terms, privacy policy and refund policy |
| App stores | Register organisation developer accounts early, since a D-U-N-S number can take weeks |
| Shortlet authority | Require proof of ownership or written landlord consent, and check estate rules |
| Shortlet regulation | Check any Ogun State or local government rules on short-term rentals |
| Caution deposits | Take legal advice on holding refundable deposits, and use a licensed provider or escrow arrangement |
| Guest ID checks | Collect only what is needed, through a compliant verification provider |

# Roadmap

Supply and trust come first, and the festival sets the deadline. If time runs short, ship the web app before the native apps, because a working booking link on WhatsApp beats an unfinished app.




Launch roadmap · 5 phases, 4 gates

A phase starts only when the gate before it is met. Dates assume Ojude Oba falls in about May 2027.

# Go-to-market

### Win hotels and hosts first

- Offer free onboarding, professional photos and reduced commission for founding partners.
- Sell the owner visibility and revenue-control benefits, not just extra bookings.
- Claim and improve each partner's Google listing during onboarding.
- Give each hotel and shortlet its own direct booking link and QR code.
- Recruit shortlets through property managers, estate agents and owners who already let apartments.

### Then reach guests

- Run Instagram, TikTok, Google search and WhatsApp status campaigns.
- Work with local creators, event planners, Ijebu associations and diaspora groups.

- Build relationships with OOU and TASUED communities.
- Open a festival early-access waitlist about eight weeks before Ojude Oba, and feature apartments for groups.

## Success metrics

The main measure is completed stays per month. Targets are proposed and should be reset after the pilot gives a baseline.

| Metric | Proposed target by 12 months |
|---|---|
| Verified hotels live | 30+ |
| Hotels active on the dashboard each week | 70%+ |
| Double-booking rate | Below 0.5% |
| Payment success rate | 85%+ |
| Search-to-booking conversion | 2–4% |
| Repeat guests | 20%+ |
| Average verified review score | 4.2 out of 5 or higher |
| Hotel and host partner retention | 85%+ |
| Verified shortlet units live | 15–25 |
| Deposit disputes | Below 5% of shortlet stays |
| Host cancellations | Below 2% of shortlet bookings |

## Risks

| Risk | Mitigation |
|---|---|
| Hotels do not keep availability updated | Make the dashboard their daily tool, with assisted onboarding and hotel health scores |
| Staff resist transparency tools | Sell to owners first, keep staff workflows faster than paper, and train at each hotel |

| Risk | Mitigation |
| --- | --- |
| Guests and hotels transact off-platform | Keep commission low and give loyalty and guarantee benefits only on-platform |
| Too little booking volume | Add subscriptions and expand once the local playbook works |
| Festival traffic overloads the platform | Load test early and prepare a queue and support rota |
| Payment failures and disputes damage trust | Reconcile daily, automate refunds and run WhatsApp support |
| Fake or misleading listings | Physically verify every property and re-check them periodically |
| Festival date moves with the moon | Plan for the earliest likely date and keep the campaign flexible |
| Fake or unauthorised apartment listings | Check ownership or authority, inspect each unit, and pay hosts only after check-in |
| Parties, damage or unsafe guests | Guest ID checks, occupancy limits, deposits and condition photos |
| Apartment double-booked across platforms | Require hosts to block dates at launch, then add calendar sync |
| Too few quality apartments | Start with managed units, and recruit through agents and owners |
| Shortlets stretch the team before the festival | Share one booking core, keep hotels first, and limit launch to 5–10 inspected apartments |

## Open decisions

**Decided:** the company operates as both a hotel software business and a marketplace. Online bookings are paid in full online at launch, and pay-at-hotel is an upcoming feature.

| Decision | Recommendation | Owner | Needed by |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| Short-stay policy | No public hourly listings at launch | Founder | Before partner agreements |

| Decision | Recommendation | Owner | Needed by |
|---|---|---|---|
| Commission and Pro pricing | Test with the first 15–20 owners | Founder | End of discovery |
| First-year funding for sales and support | Size after the hotel count and interviews | Founder | End of discovery |
| Product name and brand | Choose before the landing website and app store registration | Founder | Before public launch |
| Shortlets at launch or after the festival | Launch with 5–10 inspected apartments | Founder | Before pilot build |
| Caution deposit handling | Hold through a licensed provider if legal advice permits; otherwise use a fixed damage protection fee | Founder | Before pilot build |
| Guest ID verification method | Choose a compliant provider during discovery | Founder | Before pilot build |